

APPROVED

by resolution of the ISM Organizing Committee

Minutes No. ____ dated “ ____ ” _____ 2026

REGULATIONS

**on the Organization and Conduct of the International Team-Based
Interdisciplinary Olympiad in Laboratory Research,
Scientific Cases and Scientific Battles
ISM (International Science Movement)**

2026 Edition (Online Selection: 70/30; On-Site Qualification Round: 80/20; 24 → 8 teams)

With the organizational and institutional support of the Oskemen BILIM-INNOVATION Lyceum
for Gifted Boys

Article 1. General Provisions and Key Definitions

- 1.1. These Regulations define the objectives, structure, conduct procedures, participant roles, scientific-battle scoring system, and the requirements concerning safety, academic integrity and appeals for the ISM Olympiad (International Science Movement), hereinafter referred to as the “Olympiad”.
- 1.2. The Olympiad is a team-based scientific and practical competition integrating biology, chemistry and physics through the use of mathematics, statistics, materials science, engineering analysis and other interdisciplinary methods.
 - 1) **The Organizing Committee (“Organizing Committee”) is the collegial body responsible for preparation, conduct and official decisions of the Olympiad.**
 - 2) **The Scientific and Methodological Committee consists of experts who develop and verify problems, methodological materials and assessment criteria.**
 - 3) A Scientific Battle is one public scientific discussion among three teams acting as Presenter, Opponent and Reviewer, lasting no more than 60 minutes.
 - 4) **A Round of Scientific Battles consists of three consecutive Scientific Battles within one group, during which the teams rotate roles; the total duration shall not exceed 180 minutes.**
 - 5) **The Presenter is the team member who presents and defends the solution to a problem.**
 - 6) **The Opponent is the team member who critically analyses the Presenter’s solution, asks questions and participates in the scientific discussion.**
 - 7) The Reviewer is the member of the third team who independently evaluates the presentation, opposition and quality of the discussion, identifies unresolved issues and formulates a conclusion.
 - 8) **The Jury consists of experts who independently assess performances using the approved score sheets.**
 - 9) **The Chief Judge of the room is a Jury member responsible for order, timekeeping, application of the rules and completion of the official record for the relevant group.**
 - 10) **The Appeal Commission is an independent body that reviews properly submitted appeals.**
 - 11) **The Laboratory Supervisor is an adult specialist who controls access, equipment, reagents, instructions and the safe conduct of the practical round.**

- 12) **The Team Curator is an accompanying adult who represents the team in organizational matters and is responsible for accompanying minors within the scope of the curator's authority.**
- 13) **Official Resources are the website, registration platform, official social-media accounts and email addresses approved by the Organizing Committee.**
- 14) The On-Site Final Qualification Round is the first major competitive round of the on-site stage, involving 24 teams and comprising preliminary Scientific Battles and an on-site interdisciplinary problem-solving round.
- 15) The Final Research Round is the second major competitive round of the on-site stage, entered by 8 teams based on the Qualification Round results, and comprising research laboratory work, data processing and defense of results.

Article 2. Objectives and Principles of the Olympiad

- 2.1. The objectives of the Olympiad are to develop research thinking, experimental skills, data analysis, scientific communication, teamwork and a culture of evidence-based discussion.
- 2.2. The Olympiad shall be conducted on the principles of equal conditions, scientific correctness, reproducibility, safety, objectivity of assessment, academic integrity, respectful conduct and documented decision-making.
- 2.3. Scientific content and the quality of evidence shall take priority over the external presentation of a performance.

Article 3. Organizers and Governing Bodies

- 3.1. The initiators and Co-Chairs of the Organizing Committee are Nurmukhammed Kydyrmollauly and Nurislam Sailaubek.
- 3.2. The Organizing Committee approves the calendar, tasks, composition of working bodies, registration procedure, scoring system, schedule, official communications, results and awards.
- 3.3. To prepare the Olympiad, the Organizing Committee establishes functions for project management, finance, technical support, safety, human resources, communications, SMM and partnerships.
- 3.4. Support from an educational institution does not automatically create an obligation to finance the Olympiad or provide premises, equipment, transport or accommodation without a separate written agreement.
- 3.5. The composition of the Scientific and Methodological Committee, Jury, Appeal Commission, Laboratory Supervisors and other specialists shall be approved before the relevant stage begins. A working draft may state that the “composition is being formed”.

Article 4. Jury, Appeal Commission and Laboratory Supervisors

- 4.1. At least four Jury members are recommended for each Scientific Battle room, one of whom shall be appointed Chief Judge of the room. With 24 teams and eight parallel groups, the preliminary requirement is up to 32 Jury members.
- 4.2. Jury members shall have relevant subject qualifications and research, laboratory, teaching or olympiad experience appropriate to the task being assessed.

- 4.3. Before assessment begins, a Jury member shall disclose any conflict of interest, including mentoring, teaching, family relationship, direct project supervision or another connection with a team. The Organizing Committee may recuse such a judge.
- 4.4. The Appeal Commission shall consist of at least three persons. A person whose decision is being appealed, or a person with a conflict of interest, may not participate in the review.
- 4.5. The laboratory component shall be conducted under the supervision of Laboratory Supervisors, technical specialists and the person responsible for safety. The composition shall be appointed after the venue, equipment and tasks have been confirmed.
- 4.6. All material decisions of the Jury, Chief Judge, Appeal Commission and safety officers shall be recorded in writing or in the official electronic system.

Article 5. Participants and Team Composition

- 5.1. Students in grades 9–11 are eligible to participate, as are grade 12 students in a twelve-year education system. An eighth-grade student may be admitted exceptionally by decision of the Organizing Committee.
- 5.2. A team shall consist of three or four active participants and shall appoint a captain. Reserve participants are permitted only where expressly provided for in the annual rules.
- 5.3. A participant may not be registered simultaneously in more than one team and may not serve, in the same edition of the Olympiad, as a Jury member, task author or official organizer.
- 5.4. For the on-site final, minor participants shall provide the required consent of their legal representatives, information on medical restrictions and confirmation that they have read the safety rules.

Article 6. Registration, Language and Official Communication

- 6.1. Registration dates, quotas, required documents, technical requirements and admission procedures shall be published by the Organizing Committee through the Official Resources of the Olympiad.
- 6.2. English is the official language of all competitive stages of the Olympiad. Tasks, solutions, presentations, oral defenses, questions, answers and scientific discussions shall be conducted in English unless the Organizing Committee has established a written exception in advance for a specific organizational procedure.
- 6.3. Organizational announcements may additionally be provided in Kazakh and Russian. In the event of discrepancies, the officially approved version designated by the Organizing Committee shall prevail.
- 6.4. All dates and deadlines shall be interpreted according to Almaty time (UTC+5), unless an official communication expressly states otherwise.
- 6.5. Only communications, forms, links and documents published through approved resources or sent from official Olympiad addresses shall be considered official.

Article 7. Stages of the Olympiad and the 2026 Calendar Structure

- 7.1. The Olympiad comprises an Online Selection Stage and an On-Site Final.

- 7.2. The Online Selection Stage consists of solving and defending a research case and two proctored olympiad problem-solving rounds.
- 7.3. The Online Selection research case shall be published on 11 October 2026. The first problem-solving round shall be held on 17 October 2026 and the second on 18 October 2026.
- 7.4. Based on the Online Selection results, 24 teams shall be invited to the On-Site Final.
- 7.5. The On-Site Final consists of two major competitive rounds: the Qualification Round for 24 teams and the Final Research Round for 8 teams.
- 7.6. The Qualification Round comprises four rounds of Scientific Battles involving case defenses and an on-site olympiad problem-solving round in STEM disciplines.
- 7.7. Based on the combined results of the Qualification Round, 8 teams shall advance to the Final Research Round.
- 7.8. The Final Research Round comprises laboratory research, data processing and interpretation, preparation of materials and public defense of results.
- 7.9. The preliminary on-site plan provides for participant arrival and accommodation on 25 October, the Qualification Round on 26–28 October, the Final Research Round on 29–30 October, and the closing ceremony on 1 November. The detailed schedule is set out in Appendix 3.
- 7.10. The Organizing Committee may change the time and sequence of events due to venue, safety, equipment or force-majeure conditions, provided equal conditions are maintained for all teams.

Article 8. Online Selection Stage

- 8.1. The Online Selection Stage is intended to determine the 24 teams invited to the On-Site Final. If it is objectively impossible to conduct the final with the full number of teams, the revised quota shall be published before the Online Selection Stage is completed.
- 8.2. The final Online Selection result consists of two components: solution and defense of the research case — 70 per cent; two olympiad problem-solving rounds — 30 per cent.
- 8.3. The research case shall be published on 11 October 2026 through the Official Resources of the Olympiad. The team shall prepare a written solution and a presentation in English and upload the required materials through the Google Form provided by the Organizing Committee by the deadline stated in the official instructions.
- 8.4. One team member shall conduct the oral defense of the research case in English. The schedule, duration of the defense, question procedure and technical requirements shall be published separately by the Organizing Committee and applied equally to all teams.
- 8.5. Teams may conduct their own safe experiments when solving the research case. If a team presents experimental results, it shall provide genuine raw data, conditions of the experiment, dates or stages of work, units of measurement, calculations and other materials enabling the Jury to verify the origin and substantiation of the results.
- 8.6. The first problem-solving round shall be held on 17 October 2026 and the second on 18 October 2026. Each round shall last 2 hours. In each round, the team shall receive 2 olympiad-level problems in STEM disciplines.
- 8.7. The problem-solving rounds shall be conducted on Formative (app.formative.com) with mandatory proctoring. Each team and participant shall comply with the published requirements concerning identification, video monitoring, technical devices, connectivity and conduct during the round.

8.8. The technical instructions, round format, platform link and proctoring rules shall be sent to teams no later than 7 calendar days before the first problem-solving round. The texts of the competition problems themselves shall become available only after the official start of the relevant proctored round.

8.9. During the problem-solving rounds, assistance from outsiders, communication with other teams, unauthorized materials, secondary devices, artificial-intelligence systems and any other means not listed in the official instructions are prohibited.

8.10. All borrowed ideas, methods, images, data and text used in the case shall be cited. The team shall clearly distinguish its own results from literature data and, upon request, provide source files, calculations, photographs, video recordings or laboratory records.

8.11. The Online Selection ranking shall be calculated as follows: $0.70 \times \text{normalized case result} + 0.30 \times \text{normalized combined result of the two problem-solving rounds}$. The normalization procedure, tie-breaking rules and score-publication procedure shall be established in official instructions before the stage begins.

Article 9. On-Site Final Qualification Round: 24 Teams → 8 Teams

9.1. The 24 teams with the highest Online Selection results shall be admitted to the On-Site Final Qualification Round.

9.2. Immediately after the official announcement of the 24 qualifying teams, the Organizing Committee shall publish the set of research cases for the Qualification Round. All materials, deadlines and preparation rules become binding upon official publication.

9.3. Teams shall independently prepare case solutions, presentations in English, calculations and literature analysis and, where applicable, conduct safe experiments. Any experimental results presented shall be accompanied by genuine raw data and an adequate description of the methodology.

9.4. The Qualification Round comprises four rounds of Scientific Battles in which teams defend their prepared case solutions and rotate through the roles of Presenter, Opponent and Reviewer.

9.5. The results of the four case-defense rounds shall account for 80 per cent of the final Qualification Round ranking.

9.6. After completion of the four rounds of Scientific Battles, an on-site olympiad problem-solving round in STEM disciplines shall be held. Its result shall account for 20 per cent of the final Qualification Round ranking.

9.7. For Scientific Battles, teams shall be assigned to groups of three. With 24 participating teams, eight groups may operate simultaneously.

9.8. Initial team allocation shall be determined by draw. In subsequent rounds, a Swiss-system arrangement may be used, taking current results into account and avoiding unjustified repeat pairings of the same teams.

9.9. Within each group, teams shall successively perform the roles of Presenter, Opponent and Reviewer. During one complete round, each team shall perform each role once.

9.10. The final Qualification Round result shall be calculated as follows: $0.80 \times \text{normalized result of the four case-defense rounds} + 0.20 \times \text{normalized result of the on-site problem-solving round}$.

9.11. The 8 teams with the highest Qualification Round ranking shall advance to the Final Research Round.

9.12. Teams not included among the eight finalists shall cease participation in the competitive component after publication of the final problem-solving-round results and completion of the prescribed appeal procedure. Their places shall be determined by the Qualification Round ranking.

Article 10. Procedure for Conducting Scientific Battles

- 10.1. One Scientific Battle shall be held among three teams and shall last no more than 60 minutes, including Jury questions, scoring and brief comments.
- 10.2. A round within a group comprises three Scientific Battles with role rotation and shall last no more than 180 minutes. A technical transition between battles is permitted within the overall schedule.
- 10.3. One principal speaker shall represent the team in each role. Other team members may pass short written notes only during periods permitted by the Chief Judge and may not replace the speaker without permission.
- 10.4. Where the list of problems has been announced in advance, the Opponent shall challenge the Presenter with a problem. The Presenter shall accept it or declare a refusal. Each team is permitted two refusals without penalty during the entire preliminary stage; each subsequent refusal shall reduce the team's total result for the relevant round by 2 points.
- 10.5. A team may not perform the same role on the same problem more than once during the Qualification Round. The procedures for challenging problems, refusals and repeated use of problems shall be applied equally to all teams.
- 10.6. The Chief Judge shall enforce the time limits, may stop a performance when time expires and shall apply the same rules to all teams.

Article 11. Time Schedule for One Scientific Battle

No.	Phase	Minutes
1	Problem challenge by the Opponent	1
2	Acceptance or refusal of the problem by the Presenter	1
3	Presenter preparation	3
4	Presentation	8
5	Clarifying questions from the Opponent to the Presenter	3
6	Opponent preparation	3
7	Opponent statement	4
8	Discussion between the Presenter and Opponent	5
9	Reviewer questions to the Presenter and Opponent	2
10	Reviewer preparation	2
11	Reviewer statement	3
12	Opponent's closing statement	1
13	Presenter's closing statement	1
14	Jury questions to all three roles	6

No.	Phase	Minutes
15	Completion and submission of score sheets	4
16	Announcement of scores and brief Jury comments	5
	TOTAL under the schedule	52
	Technical reserve of the Chief Judge	up to 8
	MAXIMUM DURATION OF ONE BATTLE	60

11.1. The technical reserve is not guaranteed additional speaking time and may be used only for changing files, resolving technical delays, recording results or making a brief organizational announcement.

11.2. Unused time from one phase shall not be transferred automatically to another phase.

Article 12. Functions of the Presenter, Opponent and Reviewer

12.1. The Presenter shall present the problem statement, methods, experiments or calculations, results, limitations and conclusions; defend the work and answer questions.

12.2. The Opponent shall not retell the presentation, but shall identify strengths and weaknesses, examine the relationship between the objective, method and conclusion, ask substantive questions and propose improvements.

12.3. The Reviewer shall assess both sides: the accuracy and completeness of the presentation, the validity of the Opponent's criticism, and the quality of the answers and discussion. The Reviewer shall remain neutral, identify unresolved issues and provide a concise reasoned conclusion.

12.4. Criticism shall be directed at the content and arguments, not at the participant personally. Pressure, mockery, interruption and demonstrative disrespect shall affect the score and may result in sanctions.

Article 13. Assessment of Scientific Battles

13.1. Performances shall be assessed on different scales reflecting the scope and complexity of each role: Presenter — starting score 15 points, maximum 30 points; Opponent — starting score 10 points, maximum 20 points; Reviewer — starting score 5 points, maximum 10 points.

13.2. Each Jury member shall begin with the established starting score for the role and increase or decrease it according to the criteria in the official score sheet. A score may not be below 0 or above the maximum for the relevant role. The same violation shall not be counted twice.

13.3. Each Jury member shall complete separate score sheets for the roles. Where there are no more than four valid scores, the role result shall be their arithmetic mean. Where there are five or more scores, the highest and lowest values shall be excluded and the arithmetic mean of the remaining scores shall be calculated.

13.4. During a complete round, each team shall receive one final score for Presentation, one for Opposition and one for Review. Their sum shall constitute the team's result for the complete round. The combined starting score is 30 points and the maximum is 60 points.

13.5. The preliminary Scientific Battle result shall be the sum of the results of four rounds, including sanctions, and after normalization shall constitute 80 per cent of the Qualification Round ranking.

The normalized result of the on-site problem-solving round shall constitute the remaining 20 per cent.

13.6. Scores may be calculated to additional decimal places; published results shall be rounded to two decimal places.

Article 14. Assessment Criteria for the Roles

Role	Criterion	Starting	Maximum
Presenter	Scientific content and research work	6	12
	Defense and answers to questions	4	8
	Presentation and structure of the speech	3	6
	Delivery technique, teamwork and ethics	2	4
	TOTAL	15	30
Opponent	Critical analysis of the work	4	8
	Argumentation and participation in the discussion	3	6
	Quality of questions and structure of the opposition	2	4
	Delivery technique and ethics	1	2
	TOTAL	10	20
Reviewer	Analytical review of the presentation and opposition	2	4
	Summarizing the discussion	1	2
	Structure and clarity of the speech	1	2
	Neutrality, delivery technique and ethics	1	2
	TOTAL	5	10

14.1. Detailed grounds for increasing and decreasing scores are set out in the official Jury score sheets: ISM-JF-PRES-04, ISM-JF-OPP-04 and ISM-JF-REV-02.

14.2. The Organizing Committee may clarify the wording of subcriteria before the stage begins, but may not change the maximum scores after assessment in the relevant round has started.

Article 15. On-Site Problem-Solving Round and Final Research Round

15.1. The on-site problem-solving round shall be held for all 24 teams under equal conditions after completion of the four Scientific Battle rounds.

15.2. The problem-solving round shall assess participants' ability to solve olympiad-level STEM problems within a limited time. The answer format, duration, permitted materials and marking scheme shall be published in separate instructions before the round begins.

15.3. The result of the on-site problem-solving round shall account for 20 per cent of the Qualification Round ranking. The result of the four case-defense rounds shall account for 80 per cent.

15.4. After completion of the problem-solving round, marking of submissions and consideration of admissible appeals, the final Qualification Round ranking shall be established. The 8 teams with the highest results shall be admitted to the Final Research Round.

15.5. The Final Research Round shall be held only for the eight qualifying teams and shall comprise practical laboratory research and defense of the results obtained.

15.6. The practical component may include synthesis, measurements, sample preparation, instrumental analysis, biological or physical experiments, data processing, uncertainty assessment, interpretation and formulation of conclusions.

15.7. Before laboratory work begins, every participant shall complete mandatory safety training and use the required personal protective equipment. A person who has missed the training or lacks mandatory equipment shall not be admitted until the deficiency has been remedied.

15.8. Each team shall maintain a laboratory notebook or official data sheet, record observations promptly, label samples, retain raw data and comply with waste-disposal rules.

15.9. A Laboratory Supervisor may immediately stop unsafe work. A safety decision shall take priority over time and competitive results.

15.10. The criteria, maximum score and procedure for forming the final ranking of the eight teams shall be published before the On-Site Final begins and may not be changed after the Final Research Round has started.

Article 16. Academic Integrity and Use of Artificial Intelligence

16.1. Solutions, calculations, code, presentations, laboratory records and oral defenses shall be the independent work of the registered team, except for properly cited sources and tools expressly permitted.

16.2. The use of generative artificial-intelligence systems for solving, writing, translating, rewriting, programming, analysing data or checking competition work is prohibited unless a specific task expressly authorizes a strictly defined tool in writing.

16.3. An automated AI detector shall not constitute sufficient evidence of a violation on its own. The Organizing Committee shall assess the totality of the evidence and give the team an opportunity to explain the circumstances.

16.4. Data fabrication, plagiarism, participant substitution, external assistance, concealed communication between teams and publication of confidential materials are serious violations.

Article 17. Safety and Disciplinary Measures

17.1. Participants shall comply with the instructions of the venue, Chief Judge, Laboratory Supervisors and safety personnel.

17.2. Depending on the severity and impact of a violation, the following measures may be applied: oral warning, written warning, point deduction, zero score for a component, removal from a round, disqualification or revocation of an award.

17.3. A sanction shall be proportionate, documented and applied consistently to comparable cases. Actions of a participant during a performance shall be deemed actions of the participant's team.

- 17.4. A safety violation may result in the immediate termination of an experiment regardless of the competitive result.

Article 18. Appeals Concerning Problem-Solving Rounds and Correction of Technical Errors

18.1. A team may submit an appeal only concerning problems that it attempted in the proctored online rounds or the on-site problem-solving round.

18.2. An appeal concerning a problem may address an error in the official problem statement or answer key, failure to apply the published marking scheme, an unmarked part of an answer, an arithmetic error in calculating points, or a confirmed technical failure that affected the ability to submit an answer.

18.3. Expert Jury assessments of the case solution and defense, Presentation, Opposition, Review, answers and scientific discussion are not subject to appeal. Disagreement with the professional judgment of the Jury is not grounds for reconsideration.

18.4. An obvious technical error in transferring or summing scores in the official record may be corrected by the Organizing Committee on its own initiative after checking the original score sheets; such correction is not a reconsideration of the expert assessment.

18.5. An appeal shall be submitted by the team captain through the prescribed form within the period published for the relevant problem-solving round. The appeal shall specify the problem number, the exact part of the answer, the challenged action of the marker and the requested correction.

18.6. The Appeal Commission shall consider only materials submitted by the team before the round ended. New solutions, calculations, arguments or sources submitted after the round shall not be accepted.

18.7. Following review, the score for a problem may be increased, decreased or left unchanged. The decision of the Appeal Commission shall be issued in writing and shall be final within the Olympiad.

Article 19. Ranking, Admission of Eight Teams and Awards

19.1. The Qualification Round ranking shall comprise the normalized result of four case-defense rounds weighted at 80 per cent and the normalized result of the on-site problem-solving round weighted at 20 per cent.

19.2. The 8 teams occupying the first eight places after marking of the on-site problem-solving round and completion of admissible problem appeals shall be admitted to the Final Research Round.

19.3. Expert Jury scores for case defenses are final and may not be reconsidered through appeal, except for correction of a confirmed technical error in transferring or summing scores.

19.4. The final ranking of the eight teams shall be determined under an official matrix established in advance, specifying how the Qualification Round results, laboratory research and defense of results are taken into account. The matrix may not be changed after the Final Research Round has begun.

19.5. The places of teams that do not advance to the Final Research Round shall be determined by the final Qualification Round ranking.

19.6. Award categories and monetary and non-monetary prizes shall be approved by a separate resolution, taking into account the confirmed budget and sponsor commitments. Draft financial estimates do not create obligations until approved in writing.

19.7. The Organizing Committee may establish special awards for experimental technique, scientific communication, best discussion, teamwork, innovation and academic integrity.

Article 20. Personal Data, Photography and Video Recording, and Intellectual Property

- 20.1. Personal data shall be used only for registration, eligibility checks, communication, safety, accommodation, official records, certificates, results and reporting to the extent necessary for the Olympiad.
- 20.2. Consent of a legal representative shall be obtained for minors. Consent to photography and video recording shall be documented in the prescribed form and shall contain clear conditions of use.
- 20.3. Participants retain authorship of their own solutions. By presenting a work, the team grants the Organizing Committee a non-exclusive right to retain and use it for educational and reporting purposes after the confidentiality period, with reasonable attribution.
- 20.4. Unpublished problems, internal marking schemes, personal data, restricted laboratory instructions and individual score sheets are confidential.

Article 21. Financial and Logistical Conditions

- 21.1. Conditions concerning participation fees, accommodation, meals, travel, local transport, visas, insurance and supervision shall be published in the annual invitation. Unconfirmed oral promises do not create obligations.
- 21.2. The preliminary plan may provide free accommodation for finalists subject to available funding and capacity; however, a guarantee arises only after official written confirmation.
- 21.3. Teams and Curators shall comply with accommodation rules, venue rules, access-control requirements and the established schedule.

Article 22. Amendments, Force Majeure and Entry into Force

- 22.1. The Organizing Committee may make amendments before the affected stage begins. Material amendments shall be communicated to all teams through the Official Resources.
- 22.2. In the event of force majeure, a safety threat, loss of venue access, equipment failure, transport restrictions or other circumstances beyond reasonable control, the Organizing Committee may postpone, shorten, change the format of, or cancel a stage.
- 22.3. Matters not governed by these Regulations shall be resolved on the basis of equal conditions, safety, scientific integrity and documented decision-making.
- 22.4. These Regulations shall enter into force upon approval by the Co-Chairs of the Organizing Committee and the authorized representative of the supporting institution within the scope of their authority.

TIME SCHEDULE FOR ONE SCIENTIFIC BATTLE

No.	Phase	Minutes
1	Problem challenge by the Opponent	1
2	Acceptance or refusal of the problem by the Presenter	1
3	Presenter preparation	3
4	Presentation	8
5	Clarifying questions from the Opponent to the Presenter	3
6	Opponent preparation	3
7	Opponent statement	4
8	Discussion between the Presenter and Opponent	5
9	Reviewer questions to the Presenter and Opponent	2
10	Reviewer preparation	2
11	Reviewer statement	3
12	Opponent's closing statement	1
13	Presenter's closing statement	1
14	Jury questions to all three roles	6
15	Completion and submission of score sheets	4
16	Announcement of scores and brief Jury comments	5
	TOTAL under the schedule	52
	Technical reserve of the Chief Judge	up to 8
	MAXIMUM DURATION OF ONE BATTLE	60

One Scientific Battle is limited to 60 minutes. The main schedule occupies 52 minutes; up to 8 minutes remain as the technical reserve of the Chief Judge.

CONSOLIDATED SCIENTIFIC-BATTLE SCORING SYSTEM

Role	Starting score	Maximum score	Form
Presenter	15	30	ISM-JF-PRES-04
Opponent	10	20	ISM-JF-OPP-04
Reviewer	5	10	ISM-JF-REV-02
Team total for a complete round	30	60	Sum of the three role scores

During a complete round, each team performs each role once. The sum of the maximum role scores is 60 points: 30 for Presentation, 20 for Opposition and 10 for Review.

PRELIMINARY ISM 2026 CALENDAR

Date	Time (UTC+5)	Event	Description / format
11 October 2026	As stated in the official announcement	Publication of the Online Selection research case	The case shall be published through the Official Resources of ISM. The deadline and procedure for uploading the solution shall be stated in separate instructions.
17 October 2026	2 hours; start time announced separately	Online Selection: Problem-Solving Round 1	Two STEM problems. Solutions shall be submitted on Formative with mandatory proctoring. The exact start time shall be communicated officially to participants.
18 October 2026	2 hours; start time announced separately	Online Selection: Problem-Solving Round 2	Two STEM problems. Solutions shall be submitted on Formative with mandatory proctoring. The exact start time shall be communicated officially to participants.
After completion of the selection stage	Immediately after approval of the results	Announcement of the 24 On-Site Final teams	The Qualification Round cases and the technical preparation requirements shall be published at the same time.
25 October 2026	According to individual arrival schedules	Arrival and accommodation of participants and Curators	Registration, check-in and organizational briefing. Individual arrival windows shall be communicated to teams in advance.
26 October 2026	09:00–10:00	Opening of the Qualification Round	Registration of attendees, welcome session, explanation of rules and assignment to rooms.
26 October 2026	10:00–13:00	Scientific Battles — Round 1	Three consecutive battles in each group. One battle shall last no more than 60 minutes.
26 October 2026	13:00–14:00	Break	Lunch and technical break.
26 October 2026	14:00–17:00	Scientific Battles — Round 2	Three consecutive battles in each group. One battle shall last no more than 60 minutes.
27 October 2026	10:00–13:00	Scientific Battles — Round 3	Three consecutive battles in each group. One battle shall last no more than 60 minutes.

Date	Time (UTC+5)	Event	Description / format
27 October 2026	13:00–14:00	Break	Lunch and technical break.
27 October 2026	14:00–17:00	Scientific Battles — Round 4	Three consecutive battles in each group. One battle shall last no more than 60 minutes.
28 October 2026	10:00–13:00	On-Site STEM Problem-Solving Round	Teams shall solve olympiad-level problems in STEM disciplines. The detailed structure and permitted materials shall be published in advance.
28 October 2026	After marking is completed	Marking, appeals and announcement of 8 teams	Appeals shall be accepted only concerning the problem-solving round. Jury scores for case defenses are not subject to appeal.
29 October 2026	09:00–17:00	Final Research Round — Day 1	Safety briefing and the first day of laboratory work for 8 teams; breaks shall be provided.
30 October 2026	09:00–17:00	Final Research Round — Day 2	Completion of experiments, data processing, preparation of materials and defense of results; breaks shall be provided.
1 November 2026	10:00–11:00	Closing and Award Ceremony	Any subsequent cultural or off-site programme shall be conducted under a separate plan.

Note: the exact time of events shown without a specific interval shall be communicated additionally by the Organizing Committee.

APPROVAL AND SIGNATURES

By signing these Regulations, the parties confirm their approval within the scope of their authority. The signature of the representative of the supporting institution confirms institutional support and does not create financial or property obligations without a separate written agreement.

**Co-Chair
of the ISM Organizing
Committee**

_____ “ _____ ” _____ 2026
Nurmukhammed Kydyrmollauly

**Co-Chair
of the ISM Organizing
Committee**

_____ “ _____ ” _____ 2026
Nurislam Sailaubek

**Representative of the
supporting institution**

_____ Oskemen BILIM-INNOVATION
Lyceum for Gifted Boys
Full name: _____
“ _____ ” _____ 2026